

## AMD's quad core rumours

According to a Turkish website, AMD is set to launch a quad core A8-350MX Fusion processor for laptops in June

## <http://bit.ly/jg1mNx>

To read a more in-depth review of the TDK ST-800 headphones head over the link above

Bazaar

# TDK ST-800

## That good old feeling

The ST-800 is certainly a nice looking device with liberal use of high quality leather every where. The retro-cum-contemporary styling is quite eye catching while the soft padding on the cups as well as headband gives enough comfort for extended listening sessions.

The headphones feature an in-line (on the wire) equaliser that lets you control bass and treble levels. The volume is controlled by an on-ear dial (the back panels of the cups turn). These are high-impedance, normal-sensitivity headphones, which means driving them using ordinary sources could be a problem. However when you switch on the in-line equaliser, the signal is amp'd for considerable gain

(two AAA batteries go into one of the cups).

These are certainly not neutral headphones. It couldn't handle our 30 Hz sample too well and we noticed a definitely warm mid range. Take for instance, vocal rendition; we listened to Deep Winter Blues by Chris Rea and while his voice sounds velvety smooth, that husky edge is lost. While mastering music, you know how levels are adjusted to make things sound pleasant - rounding off harsh peaks and such? These headphones seem to do that quite a bit. Your music will certainly sound nice and the



headphones will let you prolong audio fatigue. On Therion's O'Fortuna, we found that the instrument separation could've been better.

To sum it up there is nothing really bad about these cans in terms of sound quality but we doubt everyone will like that mellow somewhat over-processed sound. Switching between the M50 and these cans definitely didn't help its score and at a price of ₹9,000 they don't really make for an optimal purchase, unless you want the look and feel.

*Siddharth Parwatay*

## Specifications

Driver size: 50mm  
Driver type: Dynamic  
Frequency response: 20 - 20,000 Hz  
Sensitivity: 104 +/- 3dB  
Impedance: 200 Ohms +/- 10%  
Cord Length: 1.22m (4 ft)  
Battery: 2xAAA - included

## Contact

**Imation India Pvt Ltd**  
**Phone:** 91- 22-67215161/2/3/4/5  
**Email:** sphalak@imation.com  
**Web site:** www.imation-southasia.com/  
**Price:** ₹9,000

6.5/10

|                       |     |
|-----------------------|-----|
| Features .....        | 6.5 |
| Performance .....     | 6.5 |
| Build Quality .....   | 7.0 |
| Value for money ..... | 5.5 |

## Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i5 - M480; Memory: 3GB DDR3 667 MHz; Chipset: Intel HM55 Express; Graphics: HD 6470M; Hard drive: 610.5 GB; Display: 15.6 LED, Screen resolution: 1366 x 768 pixels; Weight: 2.55 Kilograms;

## Contact

**Hewlett Packard, India**  
**Phone:** 1800 425 4999  
**Web site:** <http://www8.hp.com/in/en/home.html>  
**Price:** ₹45,000

7.0/10

|                       |     |
|-----------------------|-----|
| Features .....        | 7.0 |
| Performance .....     | 7.0 |
| Build Quality .....   | 7.0 |
| Value for money ..... | 7.0 |

# HP Pavilion g6

## Multimedia and gaming on a budget

Of late, we have seen an uninhibited growth in the number of mid-range multimedia laptops that are capitalizing on the demand for budget laptops in the market. The HP Pavilion g6 pits itself against the level headed rivals MSI FX600, Acer Aspire 5740 and the popular Dell Inspiron 15R series with Intel Core i5 processor configuration within the ₹ 45,000 price range.

The Pavilion g6 comes with a glossy charcoal-grey finish on the lid, with a predominant HP logo etched on it. The glossy black finish on the keypad and the body contours surrounding it, adds a nice contrast with the

charcoal grey finish on the areas engulfing the palm-rest and the contours of the keypad. The lack of dedicated numpad keys is a major flaw.

The Pavilion g6 ships with some interesting apps like with Magic Desktop software, which will allow you to work on another virtual desktop, where you can lock access to your files and settings by assigning a master password. The HP Pavilion g6 is a strong performer in the sub ₹45,000 price category. A decent gaming performance across Doom 3 and Far Cry 2



benchmarks and coupled with the feature-rich configuration, it makes a strong statement. The g6 is aimed at the casual gamer, who needs a decent multimedia laptop under ₹45,000 -- but it's unsuitable for high-end gamers.

*Vinod Yalburgi*